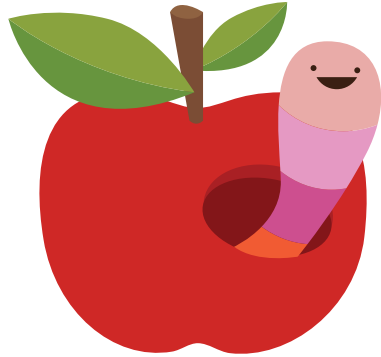


after a whopping 6 months in April 2015 (exclusive to Yosemite and not for older versions), only to be exposed as an inadequate fix a few days later. There are also quite a few trojans, which usually piggyback on other software like video plugins. Their installation however, requires tricking the user into authenticating it. Of course, it is true that the Mac operating system is comparatively immune to malware, but



Even the best Apples can have bugs

that is only because most malware targets Windows operating systems, and malware written for Microsoft Windows will not run on an Apple Macintosh. If you compare it with the number of different malware written for Windows, malware that targets Mac operating systems are a drop in a pond, but that is only because so many more people use the Windows operating system. So like it or not, Macs can and do get affected by malware and vulnerabilities, and are a far cry from being completely 'secure'. Yet how many Mac users use anti-virus software?

This anti-antivirus usage on Macs also means that even if there are malwares common on the Mac OS, hardly any of them get reported and as a result, carry on their infiltration without raising any flags. After all, an evil genius would design his/her malicious software to be as silent and unobtrusive as possible, in order to be detected as late as possible, post infiltration. Other than malware, security breaches on a Mac are also possible via third-party software like a browser. In particular, Adobe Flash and Java have been notoriously popular with malicious hackers thanks to their many holes and bugs, some of which allow the applet to gain access to the filesystem of the computer (if granted permission) but they are not the only culprits.

Now that you have an idea of the potential threats to your system, here are some ways you can fortify your Mac:

Setting Up Safely

Whether you're setting up your new Mac or upgrading your OS, there are certain steps you can take the first time you start up the operating system